# Key Messages

By clicking "Accept All Cookies", you agree to the storing of cookies on your device to enhance site navigation, analyze site usage, and assist in our marketing efforts. Privacy Statement

- The poorest households engaged in subsistence farming will be in Stressed (IPC Phase 2) food insecurity until May 2020, due to losses of Primera crops caused by drought and the depletion of maize reserves. However, households in a limited number of communities will be in Crisis (IPC Phase 3).
- The coffee harvest has begun in the coffee-growing areas of the region, creating temporary jobs that provide income that will mainly be used to satisfy basic food and non-food needs. Some of the poorest households that were unable to harvest grains or find local jobs earn money by selling firewood or extracting sand or stone for construction.
- Rainfall patterns from the end of September until the start of December enabled crops to develop correctly and it is estimated that average harvests will be obtained from Postrera crops (maize, beans and sorghum) in the various production areas, except where planting has been significantly delayed.
- Grain supply in the markets from national production and imports is steady. Grain prices are in line with seasonal trends, albeit higher than last year. The highest prices are for beans in Honduras and Nicaragua. However, the Postrera harvest, which is expected to be average, starts in December and will reverse the trend.

| COUNTRY | CURRENT ANOMALIES | PROJECTED ANOMALIES |
|---|---|---|
| | • In some production areas, irregularities in the second rainy season have caused delays, which could mean below-average Postrera harvests in the affected areas.<br>• In some areas, Primera and Postrera crop losses mean farmers must seek | • Grain prices may rise from the first quarter of 2020, affecting access to food in poor households.<br>• The current drop in river levels may worsen or they may disappear altogether, along with underground sources, resulting in water shortages for human |